

Networking European Security Knowledge

The visual and interaction language of the NetSec public site and the EISS × NetSec conference materials — **Apple-inspired glassmorphism over EU/COST brand colours.**



COST ACTION · netsec-cost.eu

NetSec is a COST Action (European Cooperation in Science & Technology) that fosters synergies across national and local epistemic communities, bridges the academia–policy divide, and addresses gender and generational imbalances in European security studies. This document captures the design language so agents and collaborators can build on-brand interfaces, slides, and assets.

01

Design principles

Restraint over decoration

White space, generous line-height, and one strong colour beat busy gradients and animated icons.

Glass cards as the unit of UI

Almost every distinct piece of information is wrapped in a glass card; they define hierarchy.

Brand icons for brands

Stroke (Lucide-style) icons for generic glyphs; filled Simple Icons for brand marks.

Motion is a hint

Hover transforms $\leq 4\text{px}$, transitions $\leq 300\text{ms}$, no parallax or scroll-jacking.

British English

"programme", "organised", "centre", en-dash ranges — enforced by a CI lint.

Accessibility first

Keyboard-reachable, WCAG 2.1 AA in both light and dark themes.

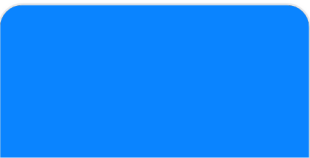
Colour

Two blues do the work: **#003399** EU/COST blue for buttons, focus and primary accents, and **#0a84ff** Apple blue for links and the colour-split headline word. Always reference the token, never the raw hex.

Brand & accent



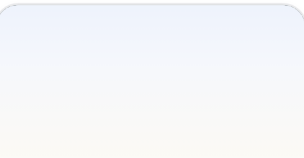
Accent
--accent · #003399
EU/COST blue — primary



Accent 2
--accent-2 · #0a84ff
Apple blue — links



Gold
--gold · #ffcc00
EU stars — sparingly



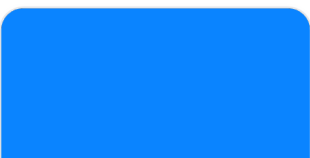
Ambience
--ambience
Signature page wash

Ink & surfaces

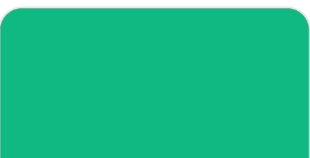
	TOKEN	VALUE	ROLE
	--ink	#0b1220	Headings, primary copy
	--ink-2	#2b3850	Body copy, sub-headings
	--muted	#5a6679	Captions, meta, fineprint
	--bg-0	#f6f8fc	Page background
	--bg-1	#eef2fb	Slight elevation backdrop
	--line	rgba(11,18,32,.08)	Dividers, hairline borders

Working Groups

Each of the four Working Groups owns a colour, used on chips, avatars and filters.



WG1
--wg-1 · #0a84ff
Building the network



WG2
--wg-2 · #10b981
Green



WG3
--wg-3 · #8b5cf6
Violet



WG4
--wg-4 · #f59e0b
Next generation — amber

Glass

The workhorse surface: `rgba(255,255,255,.55)` fill with `saturate(160%) blur(18px)` backdrop, a `rgba(255,255,255,.6)` border, and a soft blue-grey shadow. A stronger `.72` fill serves the sticky nav and emphasis cards.

03

Typography

Lexend carries display and headings (400–700, tracking $-.02\text{em}$, high x-height). **Inter** handles body and UI (400–800, $-.005\text{em}$, line-height 1.55). A **monospace** stack carries eyebrows, dates and meta lines — a precise "programme listing" feel. Never skip a heading level.

H1

Lexend 700
clamp 2.4–4.4rem
ls $-.035\text{em}$

European security knowledge

H2

Lexend 700
clamp 1.8–2.6rem

A directory you can search

H3

Lexend 600
1.25rem

Working Group objectives

Lede

Inter 400
clamp 1.05–1.2rem

The annual gathering of Europe's security studies community.

Body

Inter 400
1rem · lh 1.55

Bridge the academia–policy divide by convening scholars, practitioners and policymakers around shared questions.

Eyebrow

Mono 600
.78rem · ls .14em

COST ACTION · EUROPEAN COOPERATION

Weights

<code>--fw-light</code>	300	Lexend Light
<code>--fw-regular</code>	400	Inter Regular
<code>--fw-medium</code>	500	Inter Medium
<code>--fw-semibold</code>	600	Lexend Semibold
<code>--fw-bold</code>	700	Lexend Bold
<code>--fw-heavy</code>	800	Inter Heavy

Families

<code>--font-display</code>	Lexend → Inter → SF Pro Display
<code>--font-body</code>	Inter → SF Pro Text → system
<code>--font-mono</code>	ui-monospace → SF Mono → Menlo

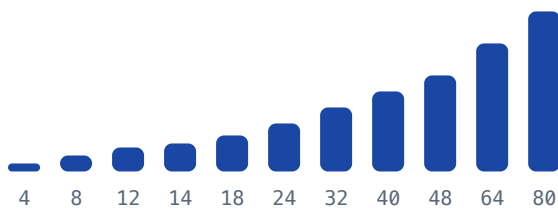
Line-heights: `--lh-tight 1.15` (headings), `--lh-body 1.55` (copy). Tracking: `--ls-eyebrow .14em`.

04

Spacing, radii & layout

An 8px-ish rhythm with a few in-between steps the site leans on (13/14/18/22px paddings on buttons and cards).

Spacing scale



Radii



Content maxes at **1180px** (nav 1200px) with 24px gutters. Grids use `auto-fill` / `minmax()` so they reflow continuously — no fixed mobile breakpoint, just soft shifts below 880px and 600px.

05

Elevation & motion

Shadows

--shadow-sm
Resting hairline lift

--shadow-md
Cards at rest

--shadow-lg
Cards on hover

Motion

<code>--ease</code>	cubic-bezier(.22,.61,.36,1)
<code>--dur-fast</code>	.2s
<code>--dur</code>	.25s
<code>--dur-slow</code>	.35s
<code>--lift</code>	translateY(-4px)
<code>--lift-sm</code>	translateY(-1px)
<code>--blur-glass</code>	saturate(160%) blur(18px)
<code>--blur-nav</code>	saturate(180%) blur(20px)

One easing curve everywhere (Apple-ish gentle overshoot). Glass cards lift -4px on hover; buttons -1px. No bounces, no parallax.

06

Brand marks

Primary lockup on light, white lockup on dark, mono for print. The EISS lockup belongs to the partner and must not be recoloured or redrawn.



Primary – on light



White – on dark



Four-petal mark



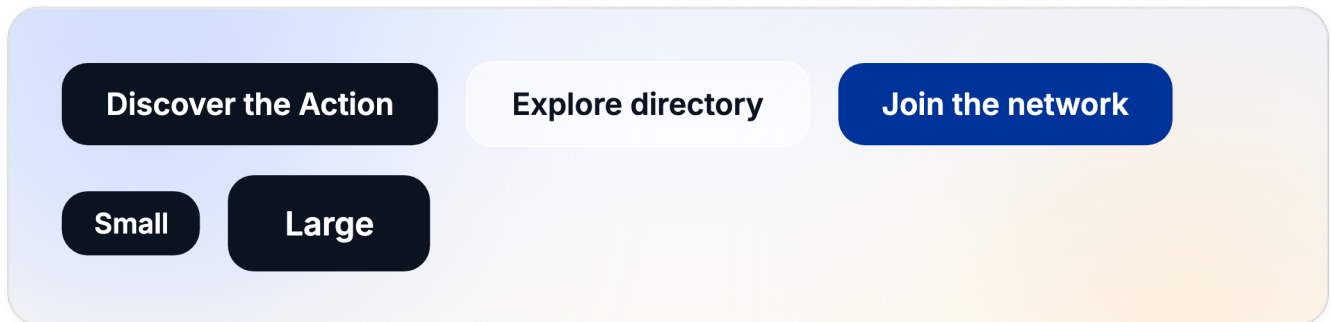
EISS – partner (do not alter)

Components

Live specimens rendered from `window.NetSecDesignSystem_948961`. Reference a component off the namespace after linking `styles.css` and `_ds_bundle.js`.

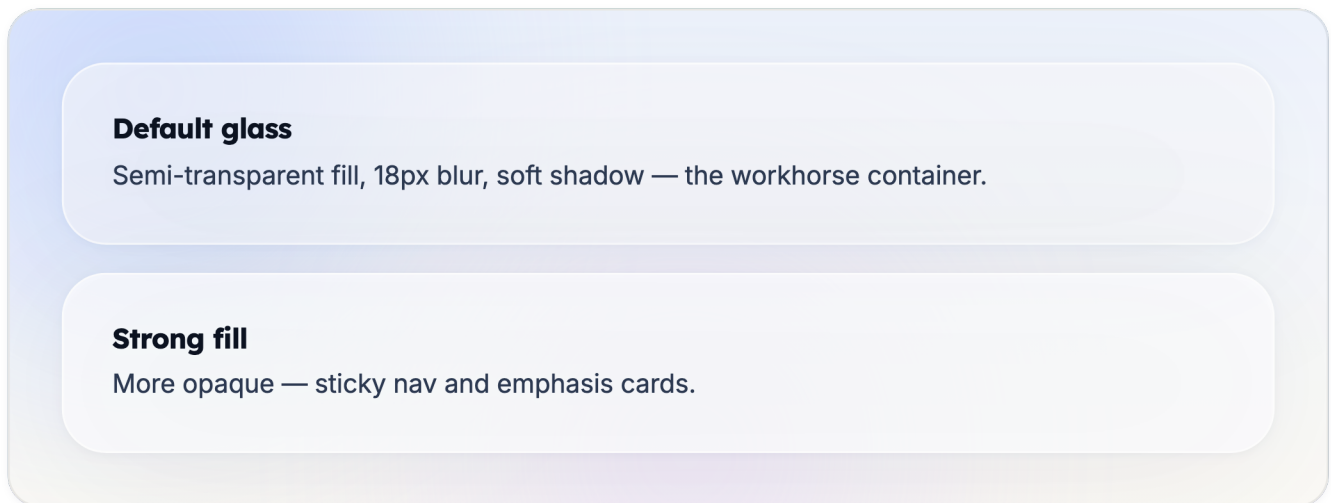
Button

Primary (filled ink→accent on hover) · ghost (glass outline) · accent (solid EU blue). Sizes sm / md / lg.



Glass card

The fundamental container — default fill, strong fill, and the clickable hover-lift variant.



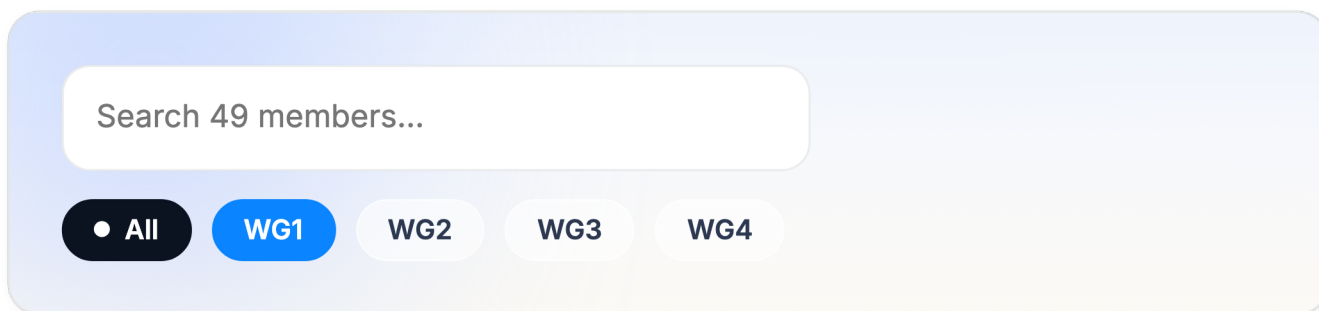
Labels — Eyebrow, Chip, WGChip, Badge

Uppercase section labels, neutral keyword pills, colour-coded Working-Group badges, and status/tag labels.



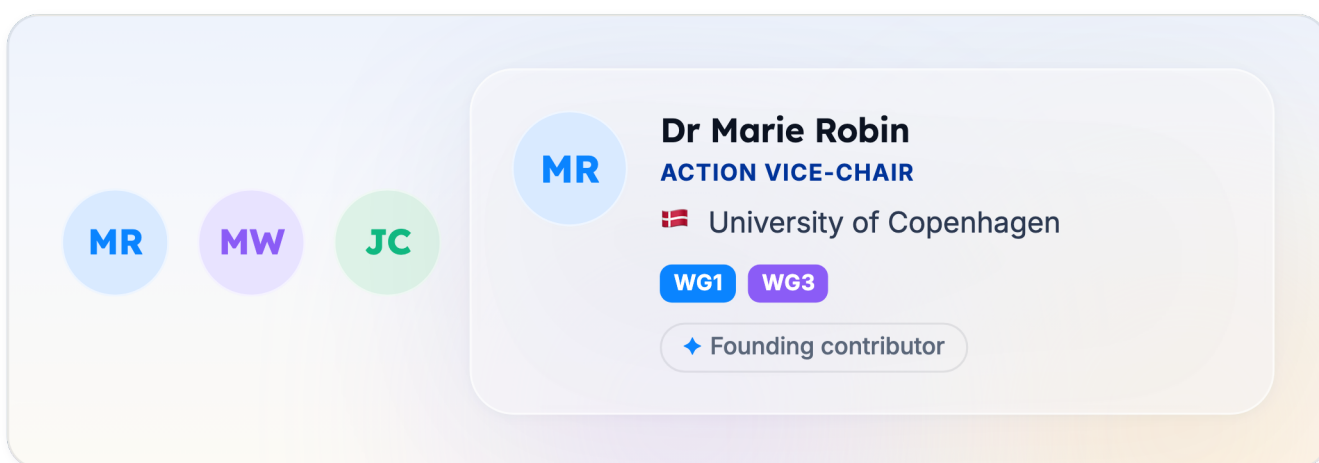
Forms — Input & FilterChip

Search field with accent focus ring; segmented filter chips that fill solid (ink or WG colour) when active.

A search field with the placeholder text "Search 49 members..." and five filter chips below it: "All", "WG1", "WG2", "WG3", and "WG4". The "All" chip is selected, indicated by a white dot and a dark background. The "WG1" chip is highlighted with a blue background, while the others are light gray.

Avatar & MemberCard

Circular headshot or tinted monogram; the composite directory card with role, affiliation and WG chips.

A MemberCard for Dr Marie Robin. It features three circular monograms: "MR" (blue), "MW" (purple), and "JC" (green). The main card for "MR" displays the name "Dr Marie Robin", the role "ACTION VICE-CHAIR", the affiliation "University of Copenhagen" with a Danish flag icon, two active WG chips ("WG1" in blue and "WG3" in purple), and a badge "Founding contributor" with a diamond icon.

08

Voice & content

Voice: institutional but human; confident, plain, never breathless. Speaks as "we" / "the Action".

Spelling: British English everywhere — "programme", "organised", en-dash ranges (16:40 – 17:55).

Casing: sentence case for headings and body; eyebrows/meta UPPERCASE with wide tracking.

Colour-split headlines: the key phrase flips to accent blue mid-sentence — "Concluding Remarks & Best Paper Prize".

Numbers earned, not vanity: "Filter 49 members across 30 countries", "~51 % women".

Middots structure meta: Role · Institution, Date · Time · Venue, with a leading ● dot in accent.